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WORKS ON ANY CALL, TEXT, EMAIL OR DM

# The 30-Second Scam Check. ■

Most scams fail the same five tests. Learn them once.

Scammers change the story constantly: a parcel, a bank, a job, a romance, a boss. The wrapping shifts, the machinery underneath does not. Before you reply, tap, or pay anything, run the message past these five signals. One match is enough to stop.

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## FIVE SIGNALS THAT SOMETHING IS A SCAM

01

### **You didn't start it**

The contact arrives out of nowhere: a call, text, or DM you never asked for. Unexpected is the first tell.

02

### **It rushes you**

Act now, offer expires, account will be closed, warrant will be issued. Urgency exists to stop you thinking.

03

### **It hits an emotion first**

Panic, fear, excitement, or affection. If a message makes you feel before it makes you think, slow down.

04

### **The payment is strange**

Gift cards, crypto, a transfer to a "safe account," or a one-time code read aloud. Real institutions never ask this.

05

### **It wants secrecy**

"Don't tell the bank, don't tell your family." Isolation is how a scam survives contact with a second opinion.

WHEN A MESSAGE FAILS THE CHECK

# Stop. Check. Don't click.

Three moves that break almost every scam. They cost you a minute and a small amount of awkwardness. That is the whole price.

1

## Stop

Put the phone down. Do not reply, tap the link, or move money while the pressure is on. Nothing real falls apart because you waited ten minutes.

2

## Check on your own

Verify through a channel you find yourself. Call the number on the back of your card or the official website you type in. Never the number or link in the message.

3

## Don't click, don't pay, tell someone

If anything still feels off, say it out loud to one other person before you act. Scams rarely survive a second opinion.

- *When in doubt, it's a scam until you have checked it yourself. Doubt is the signal.*

PASTE A SUSPICIOUS MESSAGE, GET AN INSTANT READ

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